

The First 72 Hours After Arrest

THE ROAD WORKBOOKS SERIES • STRATEGY & COMPLIANCE

Focus: Immediate crisis containment, right-to-silence enforcement, and key documentation setup.

1. SECURE THE ENVIRONMENT

- Disconnect and power down all personal devices (phones, laptops). Do not destroy evidence, but restrict access.
- Assume all calls, visits, and texts are monitored and recorded.

2. EXERCISE RIGHT TO SILENCE

- Assert clearly: "I am exercising my right to remain silent and I want my attorney present."
- Do not answer any casual questions, explain circumstances, or attempt to "clear things up" with investigators.

3. RETAIN COMPETENT COUNSEL

- Do not hire the cheapest local generalist. Hire a dedicated federal/state criminal defense specialist.
- Confirm fees, scope of representation, and experience with your specific jurisdiction/agency.

4. ORGANIZE LOGISTICS AND FAMILY CONTINGENCY

- Establish a designated family point-of-contact for communications.
- Secure passwords, financial records, and medical needs in a trusted location.